

Ἀριστοφάνης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος

Aristophanes of Athens and the Comedies of War

eul_aid: daw

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Κωμωδία Ἀττική](#) [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: [Κωμωδία](#) [Comedy](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

Aristophanes was an Athenian comic playwright who lived during the 5th and 4th centuries BCE. His life spanned the turbulent period of the Peloponnesian War and its aftermath. He began his career young, producing his first play in 427 BCE, and remained active for about forty years. While details of his personal life are sparse, it is known he was once prosecuted for the political content of one of his early works.

He is the only playwright from whom complete works of Old Comedy survive. Of the roughly 40 plays he wrote, 11 have been preserved. These include famous comedies like *The Clouds*, which satirizes the philosopher Socrates; *Lysistrata*, where women organize a sex strike to end war; and *The Frogs*, a critique of Athenian tragedy. His plays are characterized by fantastical plots, bold political and personal satire, and direct engagement with contemporary Athenian society.

Aristophanes' significance is twofold. First, his comedies are invaluable historical sources, offering a vivid, if exaggerated, window into the social life, political debates, and intellectual climate of classical Athens. Second, his work had a profound influence on the entire Western comic tradition. While later Greek comedy shifted towards domestic stories, Aristophanes' mastery of language, inventive plots, and sharp satire set a lasting benchmark. His plays continue to be read, translated, and performed today.

Works (18)

- [Ἀχαρνῆς](#) · [Acharnians](#) · 1187 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Aristophanes' Lost Plays Catalogue](#) · 77 passages
- [Ἑκκλησιάζουσai](#) · [Assemblywomen](#) · 877 passages
- [Ὀρνιθες](#) · [Birds](#) · 1803 passages
- [Νεφέλαι](#) · [Clouds](#) · 1605 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Domestic and Market Scenes](#) · 787 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀναξαγόρου καὶ Κοινωνίας](#) · [Fragments on Anaxagoras and Society](#) · 21 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Βίου Καθημερινοῦ](#) · [Fragments on Daily Life](#) · 1006 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Δικαιοσύνης](#) · [Fragments on Justice](#) · 76 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Γλώσσης καὶ Κωμωδίας](#) · [Fragments on Language and Comedy](#) · 20 passages
- [Βάτραχοι](#) · [Frogs](#) · 1735 passages
- [Ἱππῆς](#) · [Knights](#) · 1172 passages
- [Λυσιστράτη](#) · [Lysistrata](#) · 1320 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Marketplace and Domestic Scenes](#) · 1262 passages

- [Εἰρήνη · Peace](#) · 1330 passages
- [Σφῆκες · Wasps](#) · 1448 passages
- [Πλοῦτος · Wealth](#) · 1395 passages
- [Θεσμοφοριάζουσαι · Women at the Thesmophoria](#) · 1175 passages